DON'T GET SCAMMED · TAKE-HOME SHEET

The 3 warning signs

1. Hurry: “You must act right now.”
2. Secret: “Don't tell your family or the bank.”
3. Strange payment: gift cards, wire transfer, crypto, cash by courier, or a code.

> **Two of the three? Stop.** Hang up and call back on a number you look up yourself: on your card, your bill or an official website.

Never

- pay with gift cards, wire transfers, crypto or cash by courier
- read out a code that was texted to you
- let a caller on to your computer
- move money to a “safe account”

Say it out loud

- “I don't do business on the phone. I'll call you back on the number I have.”
- “I'm going to check with my family first.”
- “No, thank you.” (And hang up. You don't owe them a goodbye.)

IF IT HAPPENS

The first hour

1. Stop. Don't send any more money.
2. Call your bank on the number on your card
3. Gift cards? Call the card company on the number on the back
4. Tell someone you trust. It's not your fault
5. Report it: ReportFraud.ftc.gov, or the Elder Fraud Hotline 1-833-372-8311
6. Beware “recovery” callers who promise to get your money back for a fee

Official numbers (checked November 2026)

Report a scam (FTC)	**ReportFraud.ftc.gov · 1-877-382-4357**
National Elder Fraud Hotline	**1-833-372-8311**
AARP Fraud Watch helpline (free)	**1-877-908-3360**
Social Security	**1-800-772-1213**
Medicare	**1-800-633-4227**
Forward scam texts	**7726**

My numbers

My bank (back of my card)	Someone I trust

General education, not legal or financial advice. Free weekly scam alerts: [newsletter link]. Examples are fictional.